

AI energy demand revised up 36% in new BloombergNEF forecast

Posted by u/streetscraper • 0 points • 1 comments

A new [report](<https://about.bnef.com/insights/clean-energy/ai-and-the-power-grid-where-the-rubber-meets-the-road/>) from Bloomberg New Energy Foundation expects data-center power demand to hit 106 GW by 2035. This represents a "36% jump from the previous outlook, published just seven months ago."

The report also points out the growing size of new centers:

>Of the nearly 150 new data center projects BNEF added to its tracker in the last year, nearly a quarter exceed 500 megawatts. That's more than double last year's share.

As well as the changing geography of new data center construction in the US:

>The once-dominant market in northern Virginia market is nearing saturation, sending new projects south and west into central and southern Virginia. Georgia is seeing expansion beyond the metropolitan Atlanta area as land and power constraints tighten. Texas is an exception: Developers there are transitioning former crypto-mining sites into AI data centers closer to population centers and fiber routes.

Finally, it points out how power generation is not keeping up with new data center demand:

>This boom in data center demand is colliding with grid realities. In PJM, BNEF forecasts data center capacity could 31GW by 2030, nearly matching the 28.7GW of new generation the Energy Information Administration expects over the same period. In the Electric Reliability Council of Texas, reserve margins could fall into risky territory after 2028, a sign that short-term growth can be absorbed, but longer-term supply will lag.

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